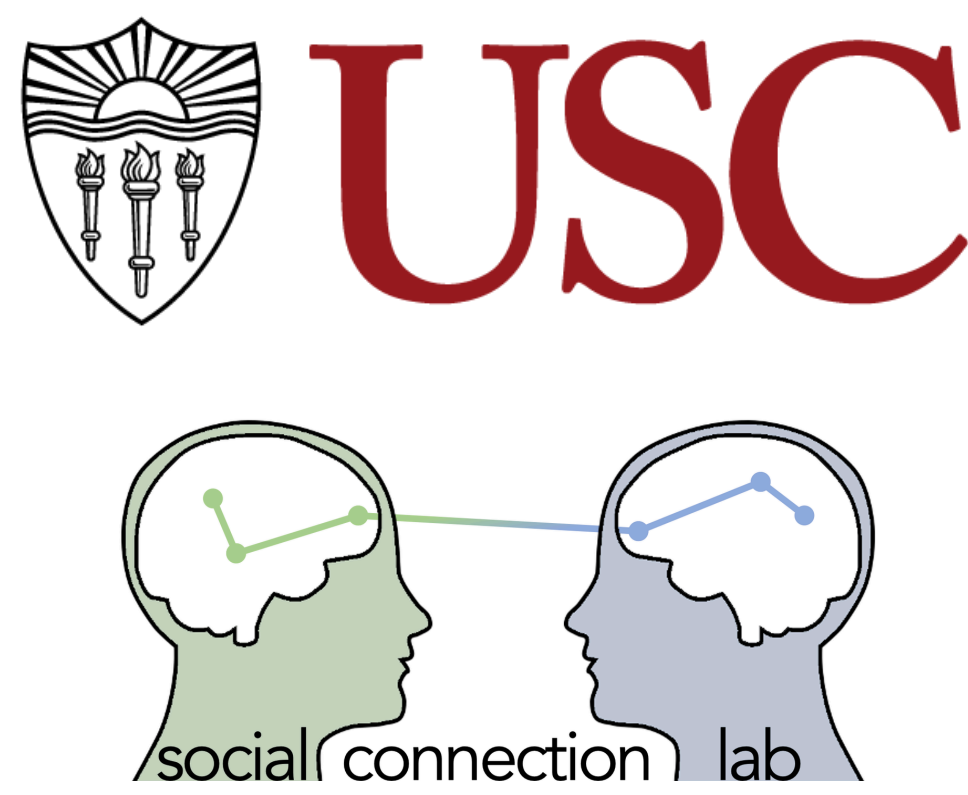


Linguistic Alignment and Conversation Dynamics as Predictors of Social Connection in Dyadic Co-viewing

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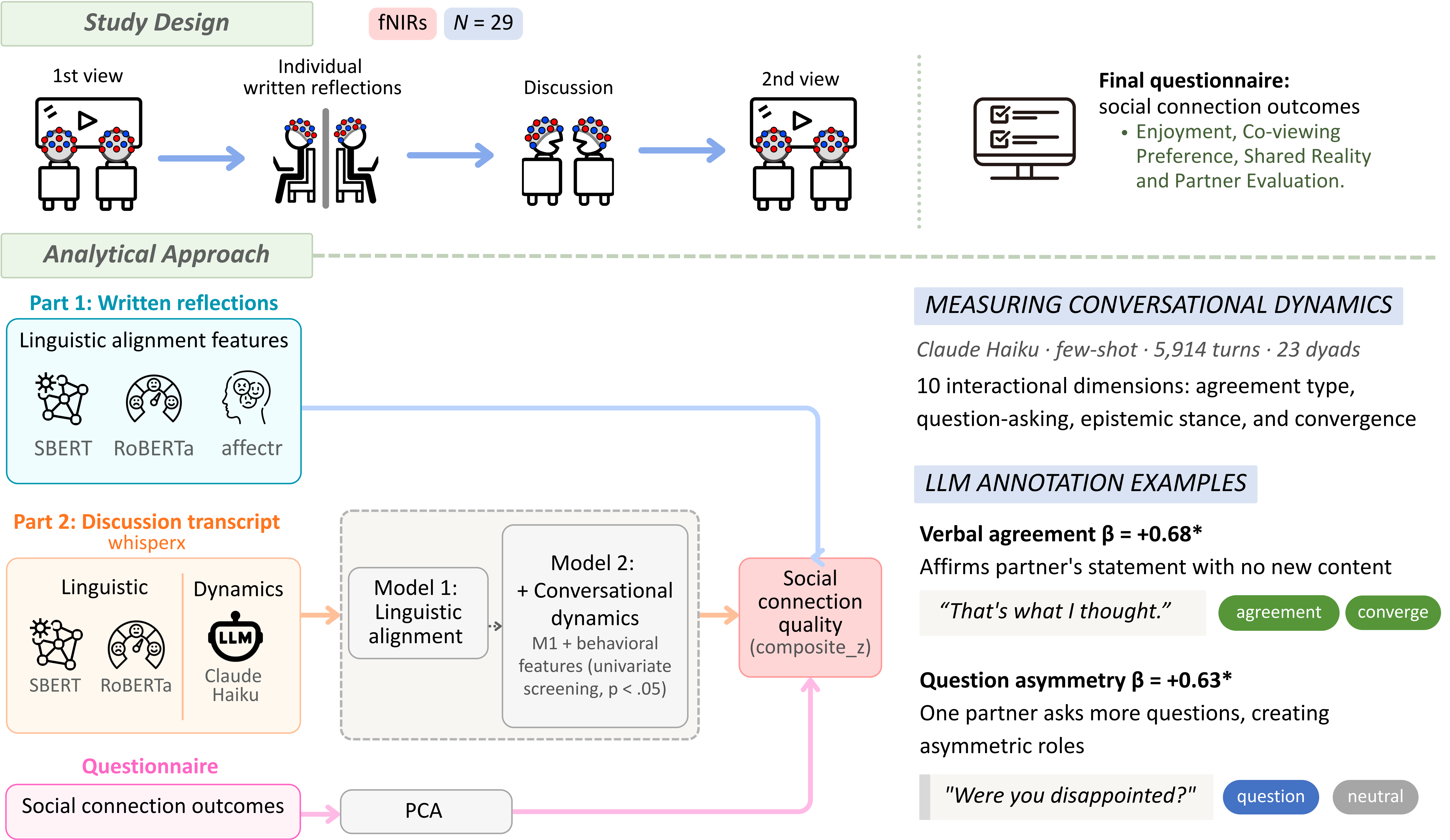
Background

- Shared experiences foster social bonding, but the mechanisms remain unclear
- Pre-existing interpretive similarity may not be sufficient — how partners discuss the experience may matter more
- Drawing on Shared Reality Theory, we examine two stages: initial alignment and conversational dynamics

Research Questions

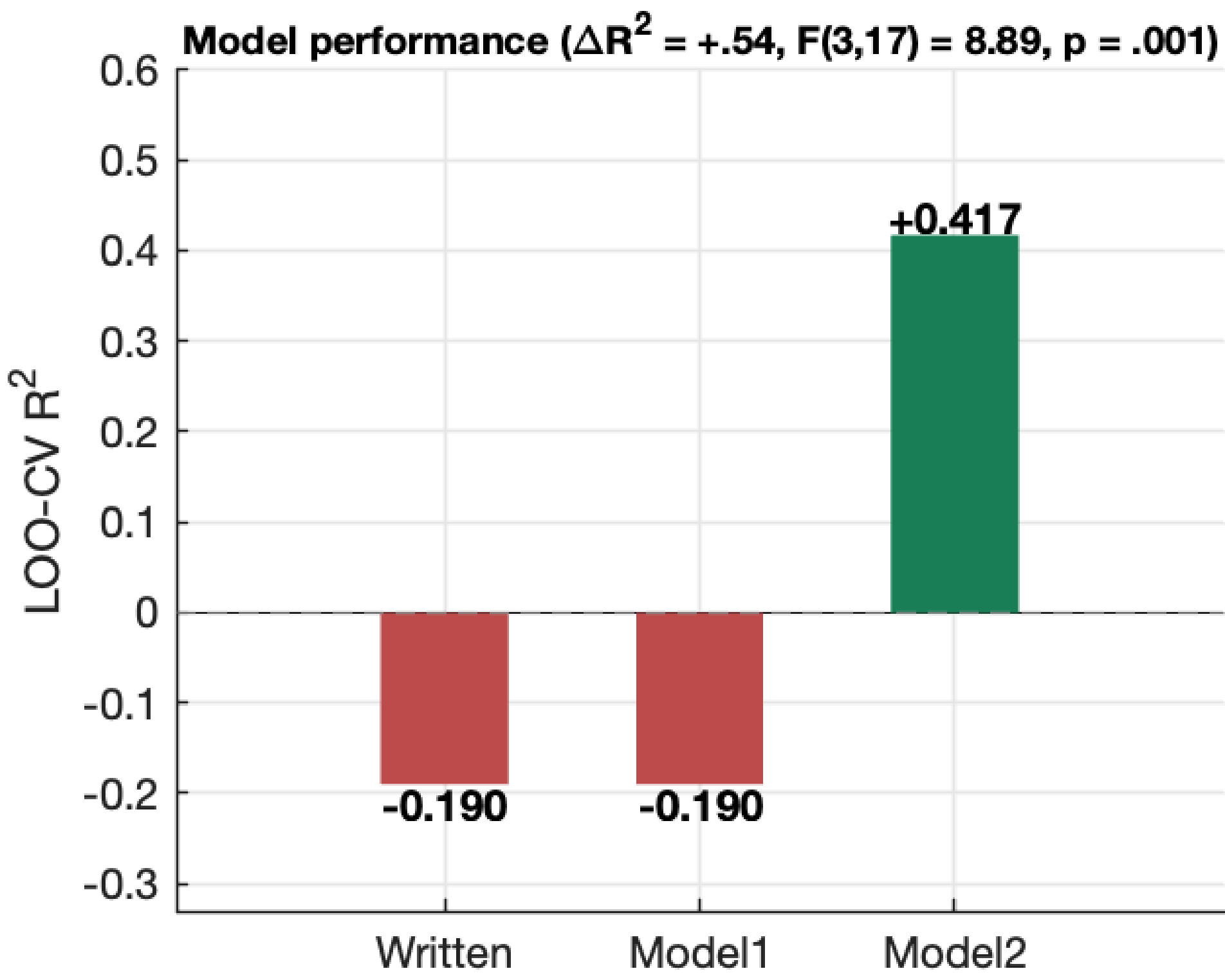
- RQ1:** Does initial interpretive alignment (pre-discussion) predict social connection quality?
- RQ2:** Do linguistic alignment and conversational dynamics during discussion predict social connection quality?

Methods

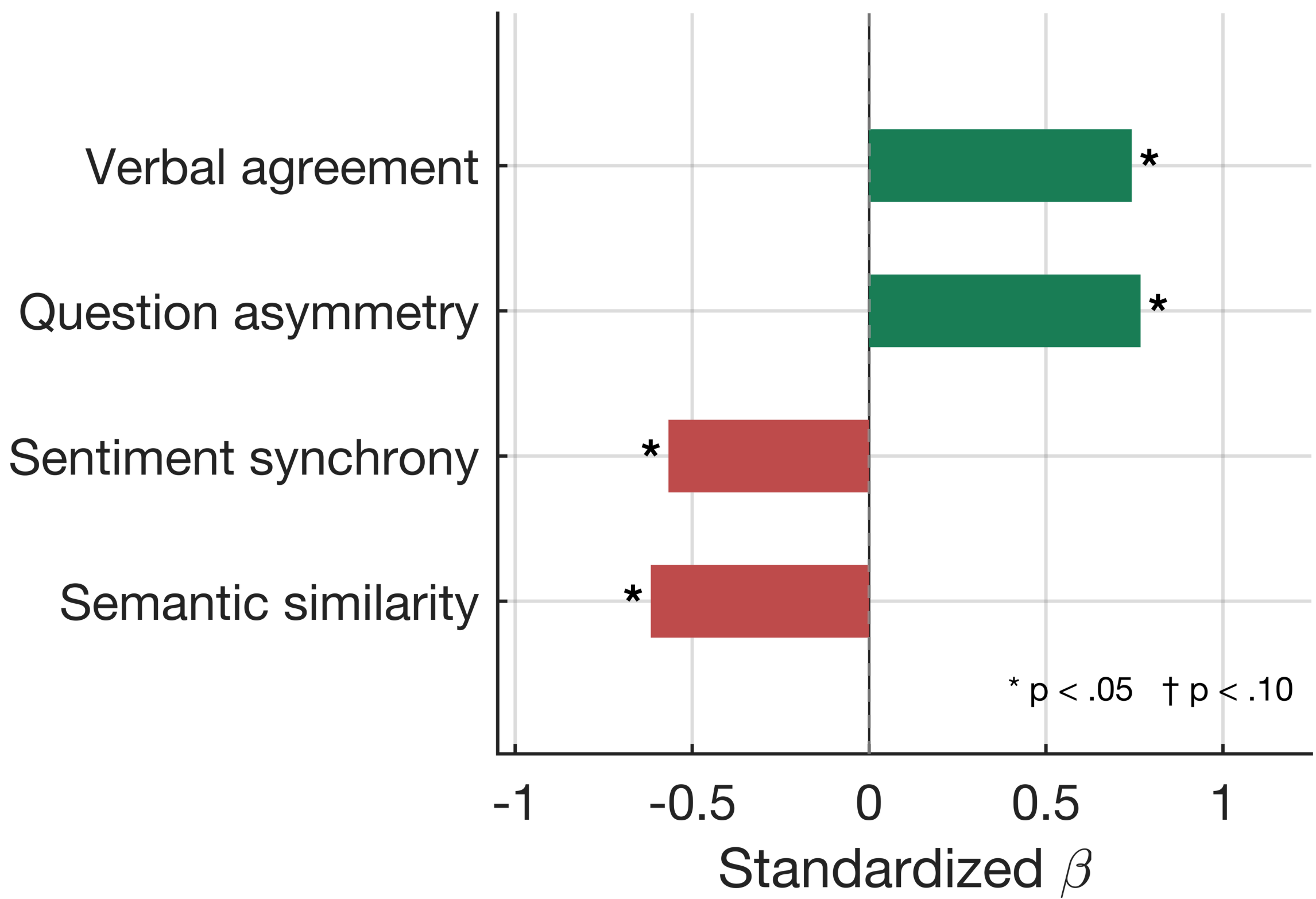


Results

MODEL COMPARISON



KEY PREDICTORS OF CONNECTION QUALITY



Both semantic similarity and sentiment synchrony negatively predict connection quality ($\beta = -0.62^*$, -0.57^*), suggesting that content overlap and emotional mirroring may reflect surface-level coordination rather than genuine interpersonal exchange.

Conclusion

Connection quality is predicted by *how* partners interact, not *what* they say.

- Linguistic alignment alone does not predict social connection quality (M1: LOO-CV $R^2 = -.19$)
- Adding conversational dynamics explains an additional 53% of variance ($\Delta R^2 = +.537$, $p = .001$; M2: LOO-CV $R^2 = +.417$), driven by elaborated agreement and asymmetric role-taking

Future Directions

- Ongoing data collection
- Extend to acoustic features (pitch, prosody) and multimodal signals (facial, postural)
- Link behavioral alignment to neural coupling via fNIRS

Variable	M	SD	Range
Verbal Agreement	19.15	13.51	3, 69
Question Asymmetry	0.06	0.04	0, 0.14
Connection Quality	0	1.43	-3.66, 2.81